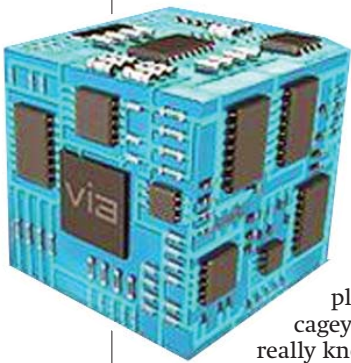




Mystery Cube

There was this thing called the ViaCube. It's supposed to simplify life by combining voice and fax communication, task management, calendaring, contact management, e-mails, IM, SMS, and even videoconferencing "into one integrated, seamless platform." ViaCube were rather cagey about the device, so nobody really knows *what* it is or how it does what all it's supposed to do. And why is it a *cube*?! Anyway, the thing will launch sometime in the middle of this year, so keep your eyes and ears open!

sCENEs

This January, geeks from all over the world gathered in Las Vegas to gawk at all the cool gadgetry and techno-wizardry showcased at the 2006 CES—the Consumer Electronics Show. The show saw the unveiling of new Blu-Ray and HD-DVD Players and the fabled “iPod killers” among other things, but what fun are those? Here’s what we found *really* second-look-worthy.



The Gathering (Mind)Storm

Lego, known for introducing kids to the complex science of robotics, showed off its new Mindstorms NXT—a microprocessor “brick” that can be programmed via a PC or Mac. It comes with precision servo motors that ensure your robots move gracefully. It supports Bluetooth, so it can also be controlled from a smartphone. Throw in an ultrasonic eye to help it see, and touch sensors to let it feel its way around, and you have something that will have everyone complaining, “Why didn’t we have this in our day?”

Get Outta My Dreams, Get Into My Car

It may look like just another tastelessly “tricked-out” Honda Civic, but once you get over the fact that it seems to have been vomited out by a radioactive snake, you realise that this is what all gamers have been waiting for. Prefer racing cars on your PSP to actually driving them? Well now, with a Wi-Fi connection and a PSP, you can control everything about this vehicle, including driving it down streets to spook onlookers.

The car has been modified by Metro Electronics, who are specialists in car audio. The thing isn’t for sale and never will be—it’s a concept car. But if it were, it would cost about \$250,000 (Rs 1.1 crore), according to a spokesman’s estimate.

